Speak out 3RD EDITION

B2+
PROGRESS TEST 1 | Version B

Part A • Grammar, Vocabulary and How to …

GRAMMAR

1 Choose the correct words to complete the sentences.

1 My teacher **was always telling** / **always was telling** me to get my hair cut, which really bothered me.
2 My daughter **will** / **would** expect me to give her lifts everywhere. I'm glad she doesn't expect that anymore.
3 I **used to** / **would** think politics could change the world for the better, but I was wrong.
4 He **would** / **tended** to shout a lot when he was angry.
5 I'm **inclined** / **prone to** staying up late and binge-watching the latest series.
6 They keep **promise** / **promising** to invite us round for dinner, but they never do it.

/6

2 Choose the correct options (a, b or c) to complete the sentences.

1 I didn't understand a couple of the points ___ in your report.
a mentioned **b** mentioning **c** were mentioned
2 The Van Gogh painting was one of the exhibits ___ a lot of attention from visitors.
a attract **b** attracting **c** attracted
3 Drivers ___ to renew their driving licences next year will have to pay a fee.
a needing **b** needed **c** will need
4 The interview, ___ last week, will be shown on TV next Monday.
a recorded **b** was recorded **c** recording
5 What she ___ walking her dog in the forest.
a enjoys **b** enjoys is **c** does enjoy
6 What we ___ all the meals for the week on Sundays. Then we heat them up when we need them.
a do prepare **b** do prepare is **c** do is prepare
7 What I'm ___ a list of places I want to see when I'm on holiday.
a do is making **b** doing is make **c** doing is making
8 What they ___ a taxi home. That's why they arrived before us.
a did was take **b** did take was **c** took

/8

3 Complete the sentences with the words and phrases in the box. There are two words or phrases you do not need.

did the same do had has not one so some

1 Tristan hasn't had his lunch, but Andrew _____.
2 A: Do you think we'll get there on time?
B: I expect _____. There's not much traffic.
3 I called the shop and _____ an argument with the manager about the poor service.
4 Rhiannon bought a new phone and Marina _____.
5 They don't want to go to bed yet, but we _____.
6 Don't worry if you haven't got much money. I've got _____.

/6

VOCABULARY

4 Complete the sentences with the correct form of the phrases in the box. There are two phrases you do not need.

be on the same wavelength bump into come between confide in fall out hang around party with

1 I hope nothing ever _____ you and me. You're the best friend I've ever had.
2 When I was feeling down, Mohammed was the only person I could _____ about my problems.
3 I'm afraid we _____. We disagree about absolutely everything.
4 My son and his friends _____ together at the shopping centre most afternoons after school.
5 They used to be very close, but they _____ recently and now they don't talk to each other.

/5

5 Choose the correct words to complete the sentences.

1 Our offices are rather old now so we're planning to **merge** / **modernise** them in the near future.
2 The council is planning to **reconstruct** / **refurbish** the old library which burnt down last year.
3 I prefer living on the **inner-city** / **outskirts** because it's more peaceful than the city centre.
4 This used to be a **residence** / **residential** area, but there are lots of offices here nowadays.
5 The meat is cooked in a **doughy** / **rich** sauce, which is made with butter and cream.

/5

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6 Complete the sentences with words and phrases for winning and losing.

1 I can't believe he just tripped that player up. That's **d** _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ **l** behaviour.
2 Don't try and cheat because you won't **g** _ **t a** _ _ **y w**_ _ **h** it!
3 Williamson is the **u** _ _ _ _ _ _ **g** in this match so he's not expected to win.
4 The football team is **u** _ _ _ _ _ _ **n** so far this season. Let's see if they can win again today.
5 They're going to **p** _ _ **y f** _ _ **t** _ _ **e** now to see if they can score a point in the last few minutes.

/5

7 Match the sentence beginnings (1–5) with the sentence endings (a–e).

1 We're looking for someone who knows ___
2 By using the latest technology, we hope to gain ___
3 I didn't feel I could fulfil ___
4 The company wants to forge ___
5 I told Roberto the bad news and he took it ___

a my true potential in my last job.
b a competitive edge over our rivals.
c partnerships with community organisations.
d a lot better than I expected.
e car maintenance inside and out.

/5

HOW TO …

8 Complete the conversations with the words and phrases in the box.

Conversation 1

blown away **catch me** **'d sooner** **get an adrenalin rush** **no way**

A: I was thinking about doing a parachute jump to raise money for charity.
B: You wouldn't [1]_____ doing that.
A: Really? Apparently, you [2]_____ like nothing else you've experienced.
B: That's what I'm afraid of! I [3]_____ do something with my feet firmly on the ground.
A: Come on! You'd be [4]_____. It's an experience you'd never forget.
B: Sorry, but [5]_____ would I ever jump out of an aeroplane with just a piece of silk to stop me hitting the ground at top speed.

Conversation 2

effective **initiative** **perks** **turnover** **waste of time**

A: Have you heard that the company is introducing a(n) [6]_____ to attract new talent?
B: I hadn't actually. It sounds like a(n) [7]_____ though because the conditions are terrible. Who'd want to work here?
A: I see your point, but we do need more dynamic people to help the company grow. If we can increase [8]_____, it will be good for everyone.
B: Well, if you ask me, there should be better job [9]_____.
A: I have to agree with you there. Better incentives would certainly be [10]_____ in motivating staff and attracting new talent.

/10

Total: /50

Part B • Listening and Reading

LISTENING

1 [Audio PT1.01] Listen to five speakers discussing how their friendships have changed since childhood. Match the speakers (1–5) with the statements (A–E).

1 Max: ___
2 Charlotte: ___
3 Jason: ___
4 Helena: ___
5 Paul: ___

A I stopped spending time with my childhood friends because we didn't have much in common.
B I have drifted apart from my childhood friends, but my new friends have similar interests to them.
C I seem to have different childhood memories from one of my old school friends.
D I developed a different attitude to friendships after becoming an adult.
E I stopped spending time with my closest childhood friend after we had an argument.

/5

2 [Audio PT1.01] Listen again. Choose the correct answer (A, B or C).

1 Max mentions that
A he has clicked with people he has met at the gym.
B he sometimes bumps into his childhood friends.
C he found it hard to make friends at the gym.

2 Charlotte and Matthew
A didn't have any other friends.
B became friends again as adults.
C liked each other immediately.

3 Jason felt guilty about
A falling out with his childhood friends.
B the way he had behaved with his childhood friends.
C not getting in touch with his childhood friends.

4 Helena didn't expect
A to share a desk with her friend at school.
B to meet her friend when she was in town.
C to have anything in common with her friend anymore.

5 Paul didn't use to
A go out much because he was always online.
B watch TV very often when he was a child.
C have a close relationship with his school friends.

/5

3 [Audio PT1.02] Listen to a conversation about a baking programme on television. Number the topics (A–E) in the order they are mentioned.

A Which contestant didn't deserve to win. ___
B Why the series was so successful. ___
C Why winning is so important to some people. ___
D Which participants the speakers enjoyed watching. ___
E How the speakers felt at the end of the series. ___

/5

4 [Audio PT1.02] Listen again. Are the statements True (T) or False (F)?

1 Julia isn't normally inclined to watch programmes about baking. **T** / **F**
2 Eric thinks the British have a special interest in cooking. **T** / **F**
3 Julia thought the participants on the baking show were too competitive. **T** / **F**
4 Julia thinks Briony should be proud of herself. **T** / **F**
5 Eric thought that Clive had a good knowledge of baking. **T** / **F**

/5

READING

5 Read the text about Britain's largest private home. Number the topics (A–E) in the order they are mentioned.

A Industrial activity in the surrounding area ___
B The size and scale of Wentworth Woodhouse ___
C Origins of the Wentworth Woodhouse estate ___
D The current state of the estate ___
E Renovations carried out by Watson-Wentworth ___

/5

A History of Transformation: Wentworth Woodhouse

Despite being the largest private residence in the UK, many are unaware of the existence of Wentworth Woodhouse, situated in the village of Wentworth in South Yorkshire. Nevertheless, it has been visited by presidents, kings and queens, and has featured in films and TV series, including 'Downton Abbey'. At 600 feet long, the eastern façade, or front, of the house is twice as long as that of Buckingham Palace. There are so many rooms and corridors that it would take a visitor several hours to complete a tour of the entire house. It has been modernised several times in its nearly five-hundred-year history, and it is currently undergoing another transformation expected to last twenty years.

The house takes its name from two families which owned the surrounding land in the 1300s. A marriage between the Wentworth and Woodhouse families resulted in the founding of the Wentworth Woodhouse estate. At that point, a far smaller property occupied the space where woodland had once been. It remained unchanged for three hundred years. It was in the 17th century, when the family had acquired more wealth and power, that Wentworth Woodhouse was built. Although it was nowhere near as big as the current construction, the house

was still large enough to accommodate more than sixty people. Unfortunately, there are no surviving illustrations of the property, but some of the original features can still be appreciated, including gates and doorways.

In 1724, the house was inherited by Thomas Watson-Wentworth and was completely reconstructed. Architectural tastes had changed since the construction of the original house, which explains Watson-Wentworth's decision to modernise it. The project would take twenty-five years and the equivalent of millions of pounds in today's money. At first, building work started on the west-facing side of the house, but the architectural style was disliked by people with political power. Shortly afterwards, work begun on the east-facing side, using a completely different style influenced by Greek and Roman architecture. It featured marble columns and pillars and a huge ballroom used for entertaining guests. While this side of the house was used for receiving the rich and powerful, the west-facing side was where the family would have spent most of their time.

In the 1780s, Wentworth Woodhouse was inherited by a member of the Fitzwilliam family, which owned it until the 1980s. The family had made a lot of money from coal mining and the discovery of coal on the Wentworth Woodhouse estate added to their wealth. However, in the late 1940s, the British government decided to take control of coal-mining operations across the country. This included the area around the estate and, rather unbelievably, the decision was taken to expand the open coal mine to the edges of the house. Despite the historical and architectural importance of the building, the private gardens were demolished and huge piles of mud and coal waste blocked light to the property. Apart from the damage, the family also experienced a loss of income as they no longer earned money from mining.

A house the size of Wentworth Woodhouse was extremely expensive to maintain, especially without the income from mining. During the 1980s, parts of the estate were refurbished for use by a university, which helped cover some of the costs of maintenance. Nevertheless, by the time the university stopped using the estate in 1989, Wentworth Woodhouse was already beginning to fall apart. Anyone visiting the house at that time would have seen leaking roofs and peeling paint on the walls. Although various private investors bought the property with the intention of restoring it, little work had been carried out until 2016 when it was bought by Wentworth Woodhouse Preservation Trust. The aim of the group is to protect and restore the estate and, with the help of government money, the public will be able to enjoy this remarkable British house.

6 Read the text again. Are the statements True (T) or False (F)?

1 Wentworth Woodhouse is known about by many people. **T** / **F**
2 Restoration work has been carried out on the house for the last twenty years. **T** / **F**
3 The land on which Wentworth Woodhouse is built used to be covered in trees. **T** / **F**
4 The original house was significantly smaller than Wentworth Woodhouse is today. **T** / **F**
5 Watson-Wentworth was influenced by modern fashions when he built the house again. **T** / **F**
6 The east side of the house was used for residential purposes. **T** / **F**
7 The Fitzwilliam family became involved in mining after discovering coal on the estate. **T** / **F**
8 The area around the house was badly affected by a decision to mine coal on the estate. **T** / **F**
9 Parts of the house were repaired and improved in order to use it for educating people. **T** / **F**
10 Much of the work of restoring the house was paid for by private investors. **T** / **F**

/10

7 Read the text about a type of business known as a social enterprise. Match the paragraphs (1–5) with the questions (A–E).

A How would you describe the main purpose of Sounds Sweet?
B How did you come to be employed there? Had you always wanted to be involved in a social enterprise?
C You've mentioned that Sounds Sweet offers music lessons. Does it offer anything else?
D What sort of effect do social enterprises have on the community?
E You work for a social enterprise called Sounds Sweet. Can you tell us how it started?

/5

Social Enterprises: Sounds Sweet

Thorsten Anderson interviews Kemi Maduewesi about a social enterprise making positive changes in the community.

1 ___
Sure. It was set up about ten years ago to provide opportunities for young people to get into music. There's quite a lot of poverty in the area and a lot of people can't afford to pay for music lessons. A music teacher from the local comprehensive school set up an initiative to offer free lessons after seeing how some kids were missing out. At first, she organised a group of volunteers to give the lessons and she raised money through donations. However, they struggled to keep going without a regular income. That was when she decided to establish a social enterprise, which would be managed like a business. The main difference was that the profits would be used for achieving social goals rather than making themselves wealthy.

2 ___
To be honest, I'd never thought of working for a social enterprise, although I'd always been interested in music. When I was younger, I was lucky enough to have guitar lessons and I've always appreciated having had that opportunity. Although I took a degree in accounting, I'd hoped to work in the music industry in some way. Nevertheless, I ended up at a large accountancy firm after university, where I worked for quite a few years. Then, a couple of years ago, I got the chance to volunteer with Sounds Sweet by helping them with their

accounts. After a few months, I was asked if I would like to work there full-time. Although I had some concerns about leaving my accountancy job, I jumped at the chance because I could see that I would be able to help young people fulfil their potential.

3 ___
I suppose the most important objectives are to give young people the chance to develop the skills and confidence to improve their lives. It's not just about learning to play an instrument, but also about learning to forge partnerships and push yourself beyond your limits. Our key principles include equality and inclusion so we try to help young people regardless of their background. By operating at a local level, we can collaborate with other members of the community, such as schools and businesses to ensure that our services have the greatest impact. All that sounds very serious, but I should highlight that we also try to make learning music fun, and I think we manage to do that as well.

4 ___
Initially, it was just music lessons, given in people's homes or at schools. However, when we opened our music school, we were able to offer a wider range of goods and services. One of the best things about having our own school is that we could build a studio with the most up-to-date recording equipment. That's helped us gain a competitive edge because we've now got professional musicians queuing up to record with us. We earn a lot from that side of the business and the profits help to fund other activities, like free music classes for youngsters. We've also got a shop selling second-hand instruments, but that hasn't been quite as effective at generating income. However, it's still invaluable to many of our students who often can't afford to buy new instruments.

5 ___
Their priority is to maximise their social impact so every decision is meant to improve the lives of individuals in the community in some way. One way is by increasing people's employment opportunities and another is by contributing to their personal development. However, they also take the wider social context into account, so they might aim to reduce their impact on the environment. As well as having these social goals, social enterprises also need to be financially independent. They don't depend on donations or volunteers, which means they're often more sustainable than charities. Nevertheless, in order to work, they need to be run professionally and efficiently. If they can do that, they can make a very valuable contribution to the community.

8 Read the text again. Choose the correct answer (A, B, C or D).

1 What was the motivation for setting up the Sounds Sweet social enterprise?
A To help young people pay for music lessons.
B To raise money for a comprehensive school.
C To find volunteers to give free music lessons.
D To create income for a community initiative.

2 Why did Kemi Maduewesi decide to work full-time for Sounds Sweet?
A She would get the opportunity to learn an instrument.
B She would be able to help young people be successful.
C She had wanted to leave her accountancy job anyway.
D She had always wanted to work for a social enterprise.

3 What abilities does the initiative help young people develop?
A To collaborate with others and go beyond their capabilities.
B To learn instruments well enough to be able to make a career out of it.
C To know how to collaborate with schools and businesses.
D To understand the importance of equality and inclusion in the community.

4 What does Kemi Maduewesi say about the goods and services offered by Sounds Sweet?
A They would like to offer a wider range of goods and services in the future.
B Their shop has been generating more income than the recording studio.
C They are now able to compete with other companies in the industry.
D Their second-hand instruments have been popular with professional musicians.

5 What is the effect of social enterprises on the community according to Kemi Maduewesi?
A They can make it easier for people to find suitable jobs.
B They help individuals become financially independent.
C They encourage people to make donations or become volunteers.
D They raise awareness of local environmental issues.

/10

Total: /50

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Part C • Speaking and Writing

SPEAKING

1 Listen to your partner talk about their pictures. Ask: How might the relationships the people have affect their discussions?

2 Describe and compare the pictures showing people taking part in different competitive activities. What aspects of competition do the pictures show?





/15

3 Answer your partner's question.

/5

WRITING

4 Choose the correct words to complete the sentences.

1 The concept of 'employee of the month' can lead to rivalry. **Such** / **That's** rivalry can lead to a negative atmosphere in the office.
2 **The aim** / **As a result** of this proposal is to suggest new ways of designing urban spaces.
3 She asked me to lend her some money, **this** / **yet** she didn't say when she could pay it back.
4 We don't know why they closed the shop – not even my neighbours **do** / **do so**.
5 **Owing to** / **Nevertheless** a problem on the tracks, trains will not be running normally today.

/5

5 Write an article about teaching children to play fair. Write about:

- **why it's important in schools.**
- **how children can be taught to play fair.**
- **the role of professional sports.**

Write 200–260 words.

/15

Total: /40